

## Contact

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www.linkedin.com/in/ealmirall  
(LinkedIn)  
estevealmirall.com (Blog)

## Top Skills

Open Innovation  
Innovation Management  
Entrepreneurship

## Languages

English (Full Professional)  
French (Full Professional)  
Catalan (Native or Bilingual)  
Spanish (Native or Bilingual)  
German (Limited Working)  
Italian (Limited Working)

## Certifications

AWS Academy Certified Educator  
AWS Academy Accredited Educator

## Publications

Open Data Revolution

# Esteve Almirall

Professor of AI Adoption & Innovation @ ESADE | Keynote Speaker  
| Advisor  
Barcelona, Catalonia, Spain

## Summary

Esteve Almirall serves as Full Professor at Esade and Dtr. of the Center for Innovation in Cities. He lectured at various universities, including UC Berkeley, Purdue, UPF, UPC and EPFL. He has a mixed background in both AI and Management Sciences, particularly in Innovation.

However, Esteve spent a previous life in the business IT sector with a career in consulting and banking where for many years Esteve was the youngest CTO in the Spanish banking industry, being the 1st in offering online transactions and the 2nd in online banking. Esteve developed also a career as a consultant in multinationals such as DEC and Econocom. As an entrepreneur he founded several companies and participated in tech startups.

In academics he has been involved in multiple programs and created a Smart Cities program together with the World Bank that was well attended. His last contribution was the creation of the Esade's Master in Business Analytics (ranked #5 in the world in 2018 <https://www.topuniversities.com/university-rankings/business-masters-rankings/business-analytics/2019>).

Esteve is passionate about the intersection between Digital Technologies and Innovation, in particular Smart Cities where he participated in multiple projects and congresses. He was one of the founders of the European Networks of Living Labs with +400 Living Labs around the world and coordinated several high-impact European Projects such as Open Cities or Commons for Europe and participated as principal researcher in many others totaling a budget of more than €29M. Esteve also worked for the World Bank, the International Development Bank and the European Commission as an expert. He has been deeply involved in the Smart Cities movement and in Smart City Expo since its inception.

His research has been published in leading scientific journals such as Academy of Management Review, MISQ, Government Information Quarterly, HBR, CACM or California Management Review among others, totaling +80 publications. He is also a frequent contributor to the general press such as Forbes, La Vanguardia, El Pais, Revolució 4.0 or El nacional among others, and a well-known public speaker in public, gov and company events around A.I., tech and innovation and of course Smart Cities !!!

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## Experience

### Esade

19 years

#### Full Professor

January 2024 - Present (2 years 4 months)

Barcelona, Catalonia, Spain

#### Director - Center for Innovation in Cities - IIK

May 2014 - Present (12 years)

Barcelona, Spain

#### Associate Professor (Professor Titular)

2018 - January 2024 (6 years)

Barcelona

#### Academic Director - Master in Business Analytics

January 2017 - July 2019 (2 years 7 months)

Barcelona Area, Spain

#### Profesor Asociado

November 2009 - May 2018 (8 years 7 months)

My work @ Esade is focused in three areas: a) Research, b) European & national projects research projects and c) Teaching in the different programs of the organization. It revolves around Open Innovation and Information Technology and specially the link between both.

#### Lecturer

2007 - November 2009 (2 years)

#### University of California, Berkeley, Haas School of Business - IBI Research Affiliate

July 2025 - Present (10 months)

Barcelona Supercomputing Center  
Visiting Researcher  
November 2024 - Present (1 year 6 months)

Amazon Web Services (AWS)  
AWS Educate Ambassador  
April 2020 - Present (6 years 1 month)

anteverti  
Advisor  
2012 - Present (14 years)  
Barcelona, Catalonia, Spain

MoF - Minds on Fire  
Partner  
2003 - Present (23 years)

Minds on Fire is a small consultant firm devoted to Innovation and especially to the intersection between IT and Innovation. We work with Barcelona City Hall, Generalitat de Catalunya, UPC and Fundació i2Cat among others. If you think we can help, just drop me a line @ [ea@m-o-f.com](mailto:ea@m-o-f.com).

BarcelonaHomes  
Owner  
2002 - Present (24 years)

Short and medium term rentals in Barcelona. Nice, centric, honest good looking flats mostly in Eixample. If interested please contact <http://www.casamona.com> - we appreciate your business!!

ENoLL  
Council member  
March 2011 - June 2015 (4 years 4 months)

UPF  
Associate Professor (part time)  
November 2009 - June 2013 (3 years 8 months)

I am a member of the Nets group and together with teaching responsibilities in several subjects I collaborate in advising PhD thesis, manage and participate in European Projects and conduct research in Information Systems.

## ENoLL - European Network of Living Labs

Member of the Leadership group - Communications & Council Member  
2006 - January 2010 (4 years)

I have been a member of the ENoLL council for many years and during that period I was in charge of the Communication strategy of the ENoLL. I also devoted a lot of time to the diffusion of the Living Labs concept around Europe and Asia.

## UPC - Technical University of Catalonia

6 years

### KEMLG - European Projects Manager

2004 - January 2010 (6 years)

I participated in numerous EU-national and regional projects, such as Laboranova (IST-5-035262-IP) with a budget > 10M€ that I decisively contributed to develop and where I am UPC representative and Subproject leader and others like @LIS, VEP, COLLABS, CatLab (the Catalan Network of Living Labs), MediaMobil, InfoPoints, eCatalunya (a concept that I developed and became the standard collaborative platform for the Catalan gov.), etc...

### Associate Professor (part time)

2004 - January 2010 (6 years)

In UPC I taught several subjects, being in charge of Database Systems II and advising some Master thesis. However, the major part of my work was related to managing European Projects and the associated research around them.

## IESE

Research assistant

2004 - 2004 (less than a year)

I worked with Prof. Marc Sachon there. Mostly focused on RF-ID.

## Caja de Arquitectos

CTO - CIO & Marketing Director

September 1989 - September 2002 (13 years 1 month)

Caja de Arquitectos began with 5 branches and reached +20 with + 200K customers. During that time I designed and put in operation the computer infrastructure together with much of the software running in the bank, such as the CRM or the on-line banking system. Probably I am mostly proud of two things there: a) to put in place the bank's IS at a fraction of the cost of any other bank in Spain and b) to be among the first 3 banks that offered Internet banking in Spain with a transactional support.

In Marketing we focus on being transparent with a fee-free policy and reinforcing the &quot;Architect's&quot; image of the bank everywhere.

## Econocom

Manager Financial Applications Barcelona

September 1988 - September 1989 (1 year 1 month)

I participated in an attempt to put in place the financial area together with Belgium and France.

## Grupo Sistema

Manager of Consulting

1983 - 1988 (5 years)

I began there working in ERP's for PDP-11 (24,34,44) and later Vax, but I also did quite a lot of system programming in assembler for both PDP and Vax and vertical applications. I was principal designer or highly contributed to the design of the standard ERP for DEC systems and many sectorial ERP. I also contributed to the design of financial and banking systems. I end up managing the consulting area and complex implementations like analytic accounting systems, etc... Again the ERP's became the facto standards for the low level entry systems.

## ASINF

Analyst - Programmer

1981 - 1983 (2 years)

There, together with a very small team, I contributed to develop GICAS, what became the Spanish standard ERP for Olivetti's mid-range systems (S6000). Composed of accounting, AP, AR, sales, stocks and even a small production module, was written in p-Cobol.

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## Education

MREs, Business Administration · (2009 - 2009)

## Amazon AWS

AWS Academy Accredited Instructor · (2017 - 2017)

## Massachusetts Institute of Technology

xPro Data Science · (2017 - 2017)

GCPCL, Case Method · (2010 - 2010)

